



I started with a pencil. I still build things.

Fifteen years at the intersection of
design, product, and technology
— from award-winning agency
work to scaling a fintech platform
to 13 million users.

in LinkedIn

About

I trained as a graphic designer. Then I taught myself to code. Then I ran a fintech company. These aren't separate chapters — they're the same instinct applied at different scales. At every stage I've been trying to understand the full picture: what something should look like, how it actually gets built, and whether it makes sense as a business. That combination turned out to be useful in ways I didn't plan for.

Most of my career played out at **Zapper**, a South African payments platform where I joined as a developer and left as CEO — with stints running design, product, and commercial in between. By the time I became CEO I'd touched every layer of the business, which made the hard decisions a little less mysterious. During those three years: we migrated the platform from hardware to cloud (cutting operating costs by 82%), grew the user base from 1.5M to 13M, expanded the

merchant network from 30K to 150K, launched South Africa's first independent Tap-on-Phone solution, and took the App Store rating from 3.4 to 4.8. Revenue grew 30% in the first 12 months. I also hold two fintech patents from this period.

At **Clickatell** I led payments, AI, and product innovation globally — building the Chat Commerce AI engine, designing a cross-regional payments orchestration strategy, and restructuring the Nigerian commercial model in a way that delivered 10x gross profit growth on the same transaction volume.

I spent three years on South Africa's QR Code Standardisation Committee. Turns out that's how payment infrastructure actually gets made: slow, contested, occasionally frustrating, and worth it.

I'm currently Head of Regulated Canada for **Super Group** (NYSE: SGHC), leading Ontario and Alberta across Betway, Jackpot City, and a portfolio of casino brands — and alongside that, co-founding **JoeDoe**, a payments infrastructure startup solving the corporate benefit card problem at the point of sale. I designed the product, built the prototype, and am handling the technical architecture and fundraising.

National Diploma in Graphic Design, Durban University of Technology — the foundation of everything that followed.

13M users at peak — grown **2 patents** in fintech
8x during my time as CEO of (transaction communication
Zapper and authentication)
82% cost reduction from **8 industry awards** across
Zapper's hardware-to-cloud FWA, Webby, W3, Pixel, and
platform migration Awwwards for Pencil

Experience

Co-founder

JoeDoe - Toronto, Canada | 2026 - Present

Alongside my work at Super Group, I'm co-founding JoeDoe — a payments infrastructure startup solving the corporate stipend problem. Benefit cards decline when the bill exceeds budget by a dollar. That's embarrassing and fixable. JoeDoe's authorization engine splits the shortfall to the employee's personal card instantly: one tap, one clean approval, no merchant contracts, no hardware, no receipt overhead. I designed the product, built the Figma prototype, and am handling the technical architecture and fundraising.

Head of Regulated Canada

Supergroup - Toronto, Canada | Jun 2025 -

Present

Representing Super Group International across Regulated Canada — Ontario and Alberta — for a portfolio of flagship and niche casino brands including Betway, Jackpot City, Spin Casino, Ruby Fortune, and Royal Vegas. The work spans product, compliance, commercial strategy, and regulatory relationships across two of Canada's most active iGaming markets.

Vice President, Payments Products & Innovation

Clickatell - Toronto, Canada | Sep 2022 - May 2025

Led a portfolio spanning payments, AI, and R&D as part of the Senior Leadership Team — covering North America, Africa, and expansion markets.

Built Clickatell's Chat Commerce AI engine, integrating conversational AI with in-chat payments to transform how customers interact with brands at the point of purchase. Developed a RAG-based AI knowledge management framework to improve automation and customer engagement. Defined a global payments orchestration strategy enabling card processing, tokenization, and alternative payment rails.

Restructured the commercial model for the Nigerian market — same transaction volume, 10x gross profit, 3x margin improvement. Also led M&A evaluation and business case development as part of the company's expansion strategy.

Chief Executive Officer

Zapper - Cape Town, South Africa | Aug 2019 - Aug 2022

I joined Zapper as a developer. I left as CEO. In between I ran design, product, and commercial — which meant that when I finally ran the company, I'd already broken most of the things that could go wrong.

Led a full platform migration from a hardware-dependent solution to a cloud-hosted API architecture, reducing operating costs by 82% and significantly improving system reliability.

Grew the merchant network 5x from 30K to 150K and the consumer base 8x from 1.5M to 13M through platform partnerships with major banks and fintech apps — driving 30% revenue growth within the first 12 months.

Pioneered South Africa's first independent Tap-on-Phone (SoftPOS) payment solution, securing regulatory approvals and establishing key industry partnerships. Redesigned the Zapper mobile app using customer research, improving the App Store rating from 3.4 to 4.8 and increasing engagement by 40%.

Patents: *Systems and Methods for Communicating Transaction Information Between Electronic Devices and Method and System for Reducing a Time to Authenticate a*

User.

- **Executive Advisor (Part-time)** | Sep 2022 - Feb 2023

- **PASA QR Code Standardisation SteerCo Member** | Oct 2019 - Aug 2022

- **Chief Product & Commercial Officer** | Oct 2018 - Jul 2019

- **Head of Product** | Mar 2017 - Sep 2018

- **Head of Design** | Feb 2016 - Feb 2017

- **Senior Software Developer** | Oct 2015 - Feb 2016

Founder & CEO

Pexcil - Durban, South Africa | Apr 2007 - Feb 2016

Founded a digital design studio from scratch at 21, building interactive online experiences that earned recognition from FWA (Mobile of the Day), the Webby Awards, W3, Pixel Awards, and Awwwards. Ran it for eight years before the Zapper chapter began.

The name comes from pencil + pixel. That's still the approach.

Managing Director

Thusa Design - Durban, South Africa | Mar 2011 - May 2012

Led design and development operations across a team of designers and developers, handling client work spanning marketing and CMS websites.

[Download Resume](#)



Media

Daily Maverick: What is Payshap and how much will it cost you?

11 APRIL 2023

IT Web: Payment complexities mar PayShap rapid payments system

20 MARCH 2023

TFS: Payshap To Spur Chat Commerce But Pricing Complexity Will Impact Uptake

16 MARCH 2023

LinkedIn: Mobile payments interchange position deck

19 MAY 2022

Financial Mail: Are QR payments the key to dealing with the end of the third-party cookie

11 MAY 2022

MyBroadband: Zapper turns smartphones into card machines

3 MAY 2022

Financial Mail: Backstory: Zapper CEO Brett White

03 MARCH 2022

Bizcommunity: Democratising payments: Why platform tech is a game-changer

03 AUGUST 2021

Bizcommunity: NFC versus QR code payments - there's room for both

06 JULY 2021

Hypertext: Masterpass' behaviour in the local QR code payment sector is concerning

08 OCTOBER 2020

Business Insider: FNB claims it can take outside QR payments at Speedpoints. SnapScan and Zapper disagree

03 OCTOBER 2020

LinkedIn: Low fees are our 'new normal'

01 JULY 2020

LinkedIn: An open letter to retailers: switch to contactless QR payments now to reduce COVID-19 spread

23 MARCH 2020

LinkedIn: Zapper is disrupting card-based payments and loyalty

26 FEBRUARY 2020

Talks & Podcasts

Stitch LinkPay Event

11 MAY 2022

Cape Talk

05 APRIL 2022

Fintech Summit 2021

10 MARCH 2021

Africa Tech Week 2021

27 NOVEMBER 2020

Insaka Ecommerce Summit 2020

26 MAY 2020

#ImStaying

20 APRIL 2020

The Delta Studio

21 JANUARY 2020

Reads

Flash Boys
Michael Lewis

Going Infinite
Michael Lewis

Bad Blood

John Carreyrou

Rogers v Rogers

Alexandra Posadzki

Elon Musk

Walter Isaacson

Losing Signal

Jacquie McNish and Sean
Silcoff

Stolen Focus

Johann Hari

Deep Work

Cal Newport

Pour Your Heart Into It

Howard Schultz

Burn Rate

Andy Dunn

Build

Tony Fadell

Difficult Conversations

Douglas Stone, Bruce Patton,
Sheila Heen, Roger Fisher

Permanent Record

Edward Snowden

Scary Smart

Mo Gawdat

Solve for Happy

Mo Gawdat

Shoe Dog

Phil Knight

Billion Dollar Loser

Reeves Wiedeman

Zero to One

Peter Thiel with Blake Masters

Human Kind

Rutger Bregman

An Ugly Truth

Sheera Frenkel & Cecilia Kang

No Filter

Sarah Frier

Hatching Twitter

Nick Bilton

Super Pumped

Mike Isaac

Samsung Rising

Geoffrey Cain

Seeing Around Corners

Rita McGrath

Atomic Habits

James Clear

No Rules Rules

Reed Hastings & Erin Meyer

Think Again

Adam Grant

Let My People Go Surfing

Yvon Chouinard

Ride of a Lifetime

Bob Iger

Creativity Inc

Ed Catmull

Principles

Ray Dalio

The Innovation Stack

Jim McKelvey

That Will Never Work

Marc Randolph

Man's Search for Meaning

Viktor E Frankl

Lost Connections

Johann Hari

**The Hard Thing About
Hard Things**

Ben Horowitz

**Whatever You Think Think
The Opposite**

Paul Arden

Steve Jobs

Walter Isaacson

The Innovators

Walter Isaacson

Tim Cook

Leander Kahney

Jony Ive

Leander Kahney

Hit Refresh

Satya Nadella

Elon Musk

Ashlee Vance

The Everything Store

Brad Stone

Wise Guy

Guy Kawasaki

iWoz

Steve Wozniak

The Four

Scott Galloway

Connect

Let's connect

I'm happy to talk about product, technology, payments, AI, or whatever's on your mind. Reach me on **LinkedIn** or at **brett@brettwhite.me**.

in LinkedIn

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